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Thyroid function tests

Thyroid function tests are used to check whether your thyroid is working normally.

The most common thyroid function tests are:

- Free T4 (free thyroxine, the main thyroid hormone in your blood -- a precursor for T3)
- TSH (thyroid stimulating hormone, the hormone from the pituitary gland that stimulates the thyroid to produce T4)
- Total T3 (total triiodothyronine, the active form of the hormone -- T4 is converted to T3)

If you are being screened for thyroid disease, often only the TSH test may be needed.

Other thyroid tests include:

- Total T4 (the free hormone and the hormone bound to carrier proteins)
- Free T3 (the free active hormone)
- T3 resin uptake (an older test that is rarely used now)
- Thyroid scan
- Radioactive iodine uptake
- Thyroid hormone binding globulin
- Thyroglobulin
- Anti-thyroid antibody tests

The vitamin biotin (B7) can affect the results of many thyroid hormone tests. If you take biotin, talk to your health care provider before you have any thyroid function tests.

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